Makaela Johnston

Current website: https://www.makaelajohnston.com/

This dynamic website is Makaela's work portfolio site to showcase her work. She works in the Production/Film/Movie industry and some of her recent roles include; Production Designer, Art Director, Set Decoration Buyer, and Production Designer. The website will be created from the existing one at www.makaelajohnston.com , but will be completely re-built as a new website to be new and improved.

Vibe: artsy professional

Notes: the current website seems to have the Home page and About pages swapped in terms of content.

Pages:

Home

A first impression to Makaela's portfolio. We need to catch the viewer's attention to stick around. Need a main header as 'Makaela Johnston' and the sub header for work department- still very noticeable- 'Production Design & Set Decoration'

About

More about Makaela. Has an image of her.

The current paragraph reads,
"Makaela Johnston is a Chicago-based Production Designer and Set Decorator with a focus in Television, Film, and Commercial work. With over a decade in professional on-set experience, she has stepped foot into multiple art department positions. She is passionate about bringing unique stories and characters to life through design. "

Commercial

The Commercial page showcases all of the commercials that Makaela has worked on. The page currently shows a clickable image and a title where clicking the image leads to another page with more specific on that given project.

Commercial is for a brand - an advertisement.

Narrative

The Narrative page currently showcases music videos, movies, and tv shows that Makaela has worked on following the same format/functionality as the Commercial page.

A Narrative is for anything that's a story.

Project pages

Currently, there is a page per project Makaela has worked on to give more details. This currently includes a note of where the project is at, a link to watch the project (sometimes), key/value fields (this varies per project- one includes; Client, Set Director, Production Designer. Another one has Client, Year, Director, Production Designer. etc.), images, a link/teaser to the next project.

To do : automatically play video.

Resume

Currently, the resume page lists out the Recent Work Experience including the role title, project name, date, and producer. Occasionally, there is more detail like an additional team member. Add a 'download resume' button to download to user's device.

Current page content: "
Recent Work Experience
Production Designer Neil Funk Ring of Honor (October 2025) Chicago Bulls Media
Art Director City Edition x Seeing Red (September 2025) Chicago Bulls Media
Set Decoration Buyer Saturn Return (September 2025) Netflix Feature Film
Production Designer Night at the United Center (August 2025) Social Media Commercial. Chicago Blackhawks
Set Decoration Coordinator Dark Matter Season 2 (June-Aug. 2025) Apple TV Series
Production Designer Bloodline (May 2025) Music Video. Alex Warren x Jelly Roll
Production Designer False Awakening (March-May 2025) Independent Feature Film
Set Decoration Buyer Emperor of Ocean Park (Jan.-June 2024) MGM+ Series. Set Decorator: Marissa Korchak
Set Decoration Coordinator Chicago Fire Season 12 (Jan. 2024) NBC TV Series. Set Decorator: Desi Wolff
Art Department Coordinator Soul On Fire (Oct.-Dec 2023) Feature Film. Production Designer: Dawn Ferry
Art Department Coordinator Me, We (Feb. 2023) Disney/FX Studios TV Pilot. Production Designer: Laura Fox
Production Designer Get Covered Illinois (August 2023) Commercial. Lemonlight Studios
Art Department Coordinator Dark Matter/Durango 60623 (Sept. 2022) Apple TV Series/Sony Pictures. Production Designer: Patricio Farrell
Art Department Coordinator Justified: City Primeval (Mar.-Aug. 2022) FX/Hulu TV Series, Sony Pictures. Production Designer: Marek Dobrowolski
Art Department Coordinator Lightyears S1 (Mar.-Oct. 2021) Amazon Prime TV Series, Legendary Studios. Production Designer: Scott Kuzio
Set Dresser "DonC x 1966" (Feb. 2023) Multimedia Ad for Chicago Bulls
Production Designer GetCovered Illinois "Having A Baby"/"Simply Ask" (Nov. 2022) Commercial, Lemonlight Studios
Production Designer Bosley "It's About Time" (Oct. 2022) Commercial, Lamppost Pictures LLC.
Set Decorator Spotify Wrapped with Jack Harlow (Nov. 2021) Tik-Tok Ad, Pyramid Studios
"

Header

The header could be improved. Keep the dynamic functionality of the menu.

Footer

The footer could be improved. This currently has a contact email hard-coded. The website should have a function to open the user's email to speed up the contact process. The footer currently has: "Makaela Johnston Made with Squarespace Contact

makaela.johnston@gmail.com". The website will no longer be made with Squarespace, so that can be removed.

Likes about the current website:

- commercial and narrative are separate
- Clicking on commercials showcases only commercials, and when clicking on each it opens a new page with more details on that project

Dislikes about the current website:

- don't want them all to be square - want them to be landscape /rectangles (more cinematic)
- The font -> wants clean but feels artsy, still easy to read. Name can be in a fun font, but the rest simple in a way to be readable.

Wants:

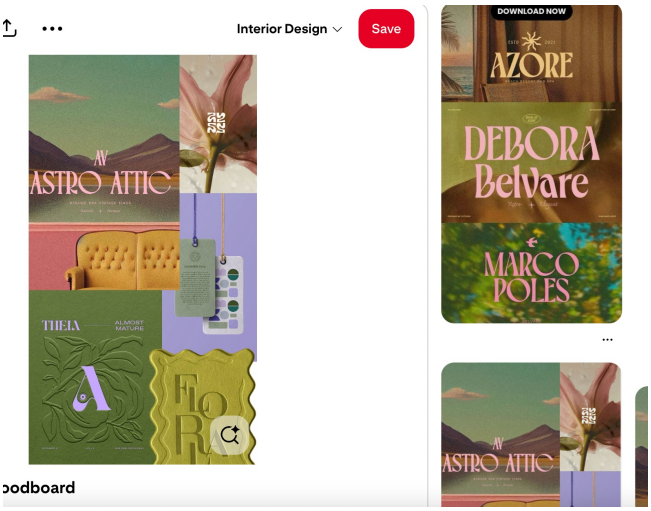
- play around with pink hues mixed with dark (like maroon), like sunsets?
- Artsy, maybe vintage coded
- Hints at girly, but not too girly
- Include IMDb, instagram somewhere - footer and contact page.

Potential (wait):

- admin portal to add new stuff

Inspiration:

LAUREN BAKER
20 Photography 15
Lauren Baker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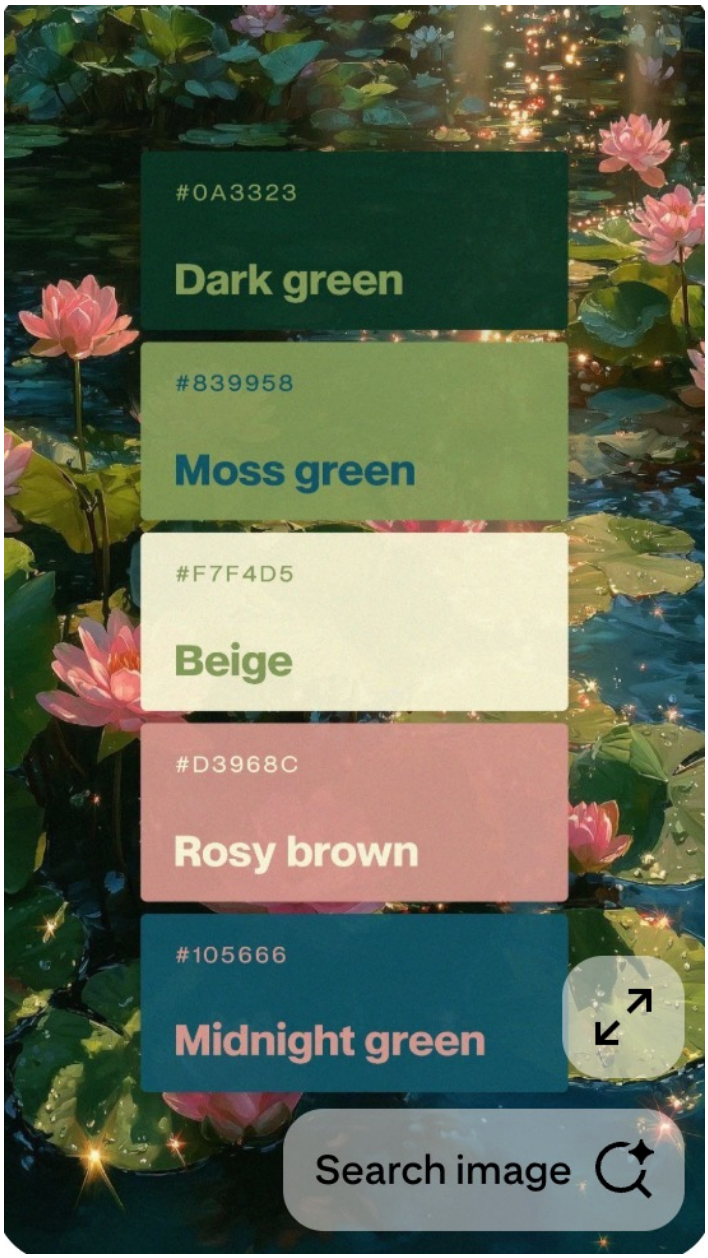
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Search image